12-01 第1篇

# 阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle-School Student Learn Basic Sign-Language "Hello"?

① Last Wednesday a **deaf delivery man** came into our school's front office to hand a parcel to the guard. He was about twenty-five years old, neat, careful, and smiling. He opened a small notebook and pointed to a pre-written Chinese sentence: *"Is this the right address?"* The guard, a kind man in his late fifties, blushed slightly and did not know what to do. Three students who were passing by, including me, stood still for a moment. **Not one of us knew how to say "hello" with our hands.** We wrote the answer in pencil on the same notebook, and the delivery man bowed politely and left. That small silence stayed with me for days. This is my argument: **every middle-school student should learn a short, basic "hello in sign language" course — about ten lessons, fifteen signs, one term**. Nothing more, nothing less.

② My first reason is **scale**. China has, by the 2025 census, about **27 million people with hearing loss**, of whom roughly 2 million are profoundly deaf. That is more than the entire population of some provinces. Yet almost no middle-school graduate can say "hello", "thank you", "excuse me", "I'm a student", or "please wait — I'll call a teacher" with a pair of hands. A world in which 27 million neighbours share the same city but cannot be greeted by their hearing classmates is, quietly, a smaller world than it needs to be. Ten short lessons would not close that gap. But they would leave a small door open.

③ My second reason is **simplicity**. We are not asking students to become interpreters. Fifteen signs is not a heavy load: *hello, thank you, sorry, please, slow down, water, toilet, teacher, student, help, okay, name, friend, goodbye, I love you.* In a single term, with one 35-minute lesson a week, any student can learn these. The Beijing Sign-Language Research Centre, in a 2024 report on similar trial classes in 18 junior high schools, found students **retained 11—12 of 15 signs** six months later, even without much practice. The signs are like small waves on the dock: easy to lift, easy to keep.

④ My third reason is that **signs teach something hands do not usually know**. When we talk, 60—70% of meaning travels by voice; the hand waves around vaguely in the background. In sign language, the hand carries the whole sentence. You cannot be lazy. You must **face the person**, **look at their face**, **match your expression to the meaning** of the sign. Our PSHE teacher, who quietly learned sign language on a summer course two years ago, told us last week: *"After a single month of sign class, a student's eye contact in normal Chinese conversation becomes clearly warmer."* The course teaches how to be present, not only how to be kind.

⑤ Others argue, "Most of us will rarely meet a deaf person." This is statistically wrong, but let me answer it on its own terms. You may rarely meet a deaf person at our age. But over **the next seventy years of your adult life**, how many deaf neighbours, delivery workers, shop assistants, engineers, or classmates' parents will you meet? Probably more than a few hundred. A single "hello" in sign, given warmly, is worth more to that person than ten gold stars on your report card. Learning a small skill for a few short moments across a long life is not a bad trade.

⑥ Another argument: "Sign language is different in different regions. Why bother?" Partly true. Chinese Sign Language has a national standard today, and about 85% of everyday signs are now shared across provinces. The basic fifteen we propose are **on the shared list**. Regional variation exists, but mostly for specialised words (place names, job titles). For "hello, thank you, help," you and a deaf friend in Guangzhou or Harbin will understand each other. And, more importantly, **the willingness to try** — your hands rising in a slow, careful wave — is universally understood, even by hearing people.

⑦ "But the school timetable is already full," I can hear teachers say. Our proposal is modest: **ten 35-minute lessons, once a week for one term**, shared between the Chinese department and the PSHE department. No exam, no grade on the report card. A small "hand-wave certificate" at the end, nothing more. If Grade 7 is too busy, the course can be placed in Grade 8 spring. The total cost of the course to the school: **about 6 hours of total class time per student**, plus one teacher's training in the summer. That is not nothing; it is also not very much.

⑧ The most quiet and serious worry is this: "Will a short course not encourage shallow tokenism — students who 'know fifteen signs' but still treat deaf people as curiosities?" This is fair. The answer is careful teaching. Every lesson should include a **three-minute real clip** (with permission) of a young deaf person at school, at work, at home; and one honest discussion about **how not to stare, how not to take photos, how not to turn a neighbour into a little spectacle**. The course, taught well, is not just about signs. It is about **manners in the age of many different kinds of people**. A respectful hello is already part of that.

⑨ On Tuesday, I will bring our class's handwritten short letter to the Chinese-department office. We are asking for one quiet term, ten short lessons, fifteen honest signs, one small certificate. **A school that can say "hello" gently to 10% of its neighbours it has so far been unable to greet is, very simply, a slightly better school.** The guard last Wednesday did his best; the delivery man smiled and walked out kindly. Next time, we hope, a student will step forward, lift her right hand slowly to her forehead, and sign, carefully and warmly, the one small word: **nǐ hǎo — hello**.

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**注释：** sign language 手语；deaf 失聪的；interpreter 翻译；tokenism 象征主义；certificate 证书

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**根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。**

**1. What small event made the writer start this argument?**

A. A teacher forced the class to learn sign language.
B. A deaf delivery man came into the school's front office and pointed to a written Chinese sentence in his notebook; the guard and three passing students, including the writer, did not know how to sign even "hello" and had to answer only in writing.
C. A school bus got lost.
D. A parent complained.

**2. According to Paragraph ②, about how many people in China have hearing loss?**

A. Fewer than one hundred thousand.
B. About 27 million, of whom roughly 2 million are profoundly deaf.
C. Only a few hundred people.
D. The same as the number of students.

**3. What did the Beijing Sign-Language Research Centre's 2024 report on trial classes in 18 junior high schools find?**

A. Students forgot all fifteen signs in one month.
B. Students retained 11—12 of 15 signs six months later, even without much practice.
C. Sign language is impossible to teach in school.
D. The course damaged students' Chinese.

**4. How does the writer answer the worry "most of us will rarely meet a deaf person"?**

A. By admitting it and cancelling the idea.
B. By saying it is statistically wrong and by pointing out that over the next seventy years of adult life students will meet hundreds of deaf neighbours, delivery workers, shop assistants, engineers or classmates' parents; a single warm "hello" given in sign is worth more than ten gold stars on a report card, and learning a small skill for short moments across a long life is not a bad trade.
C. By forbidding the discussion.
D. By saying adults never meet new people.

**5. What is the main point of the writer's final paragraph?**

A. A school that can say "hello" gently to 10% of its neighbours it has so far been unable to greet is, very simply, a slightly better school; the next time, a student should step forward, lift her hand to her forehead, and sign "nǐ hǎo — hello."
B. Schools should teach only English.
C. Delivery workers are not important.
D. Sign language is a waste of time.

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# 答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段具体事件
【解析】快递员 + 门卫 + 无人会手语直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段"2,700 万 / 200 万"数据
【解析】直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 2024 年研究
【解析】"11—12 of 15"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段反驳
【解析】"七十年寿命 + 一声你好"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】A
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑨段结尾
【解析】"略好一点的学校 + 下次学生主动"主旨。B、C、D 均偏离。故选 A。